Music in Western Civilization





Topic 4.1 –

The Baroque Period

巴洛克时期

1600-1750

Professor Chan Wing Wah
陈永华教授

2026

Baroque Architecture & Sculpture

- Early **Medieval** **Romanesque** to late Medieval **Gothic ---**
- **Renaissance** of Greek & Roman ideal
- ----***The Baroque*** 巴洛克

- **Baroque** interior:
- Architecture: **Grand**, highly decorated, **golden beams**, **exaggerated**, complex,

- Exterior： colossal.
- Sculpture: marble, **exaggerated details** of facial expressions and costumes.



St. Peter’s Square, Vaticana梵蒂冈

(Bramante, Michelangelo, Maderna, **Bernini**)



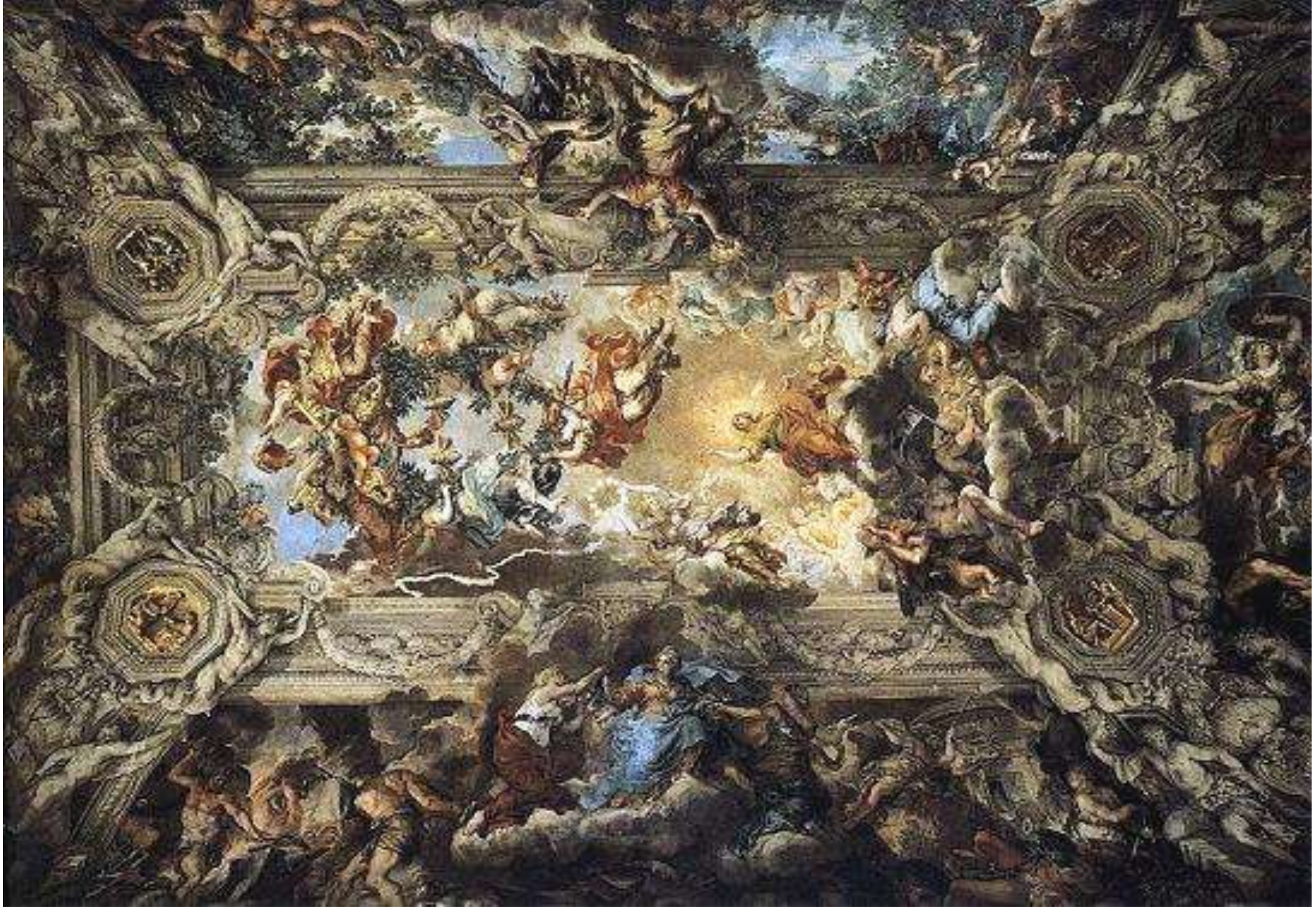
St. Peter's Baldachin (a bronze canopy, 1623-34), Vaticana,

by Gian Lorenzo **Bernini** 1598-1680

The Baroque Grandeur







Pietro da Cortona : *Triumph of Divine Providence*, 1633-39

Palazzo Barberini now Galleria Nazionale d'Arte Antica, Roma



Fontana di Trevi

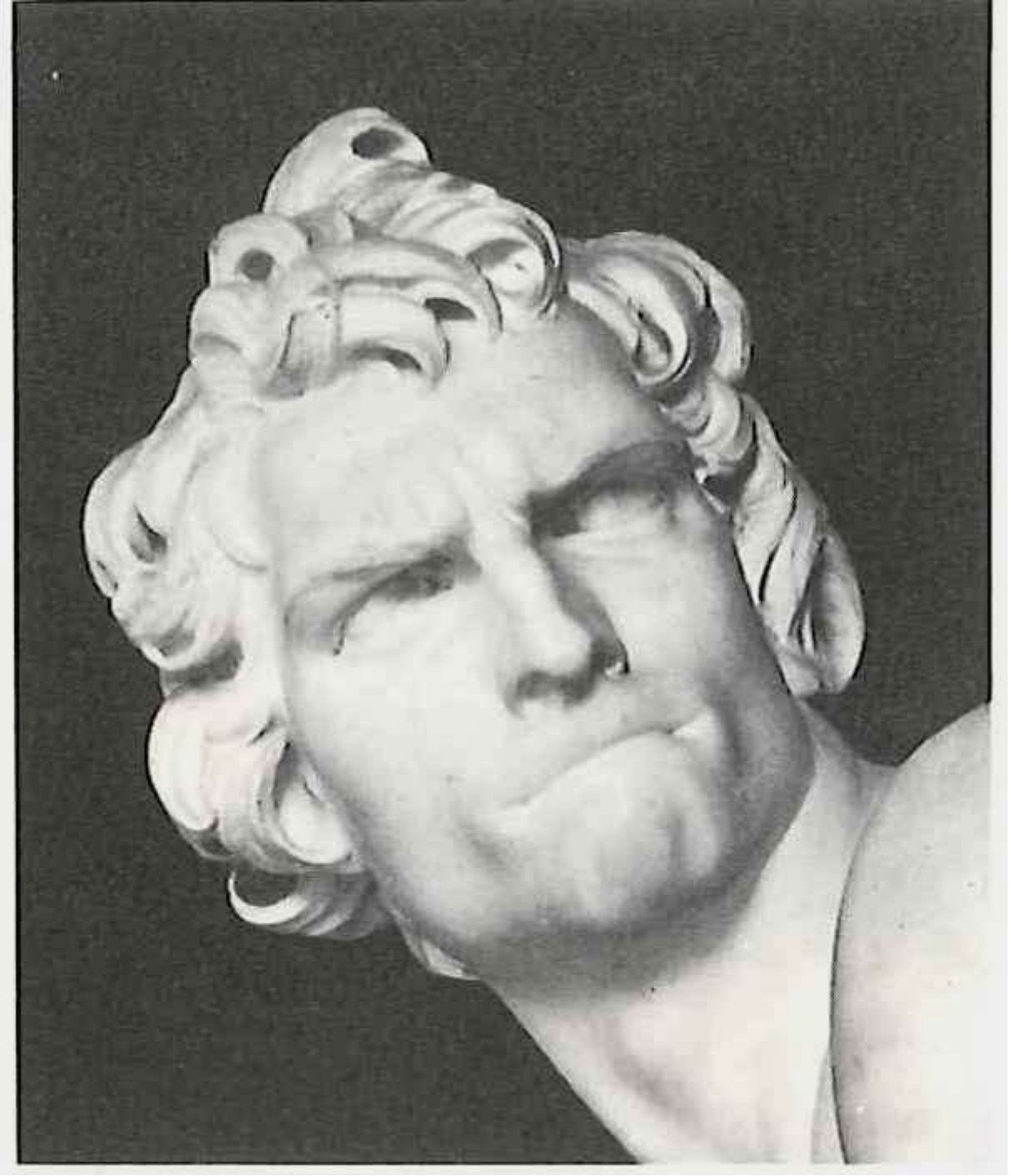
Nicola Salvi, Giuseppe Pannini (built 1732-1762)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=87kbwiLSDDU Three Coins in the Fountain





Gian Lorenzo **Bernini** 1598-1680: *The Blessed Ludovica Albertoni*. Marble. 1671-4. Altieri Chapel, Rome



Gian Lorenzo **Bernini**:
David. 1623-4,

Borghese Museum,
Rome

Baroque Music



- Grand & colossal,
- Royal & festive,
- Exaggerated & complex,
- Running bass line,

  Highly decorated melodies.

Baroque Architecture with Baroque Music

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TJ3tlvRNzJc

Readings

- 1. Music of the Baroque
- https://www.baroque.org/baroque article

- 2. Baroque Art and Architecture

- https://www.britannica.com/art/Baroque-art-and-architecture article

Basilika Dreizhenheilige (Baroque)





Dominikus Zimmermann, Pilgrimage Church (Wieskirche)
Steingaden, Bavaria 1745-54



The High Cathedral of St. Peter in Trier, Germany

Baroque Music

- Vocal forms: Lutheran *Chorale* 圣诗 (1517 Reformation),
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Khn9jLIYE4A
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MY-aowxVXfI

- J.S. Bach: Cantata No.147. *Jesus, Joy of Man's Desiring*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WUo7tQOvapE

- Rameau: solo harpsichord
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KQiBIb_klT8

- Baroque flute & harpsichord
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zPA4GON94qU 1'48"

String family: violin, viola, cello, double bass



Woodwind instruments:

saxophone (from 1850),

clarinet(from 1700), flute, oboe, bassoon



Brass instruments



French Horn



Trumpet



Flugelhorn



Trombone



Tuba

Barqoue timpani





Modern timpani



Harpsichord大键琴，羽管键琴





Musical Forms 曲式

- Vocal form:

- *Opera*
- *Oratorio*神曲,
- *Cantata*清唱剧;

- *Mass*弥撒曲,
- *Requiem*安魂曲,
- *Passion*受难曲

Baroque Instrumental Form

- *Strings* 弦乐器: violin, viola, cello, double bass;
- *keyboard* 键盘乐器: organ, clavichord古钢琴, **harpsichord 羽管**键琴;
- Woodwinds木管乐器: recorder, flute, oboe, bassoon
- **Instrumental forms:**
- Sonata 奏鸣曲,
- Suite组曲,
- Fugue赋格曲,
- Concerto协奏曲,
- Trio Sonata三重奏鸣曲,

The Baroque Energy & Vitality

Bach: *Brandenburg Concerto No.1* in F major, BWV 1046
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rz_KFLHjquc

Bach: *Brandenburg Concerto No.2 in F major,* BWV 1047
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VC24gV1o7XQ&list=RDVC24gV1o7XQ&start_radio=1
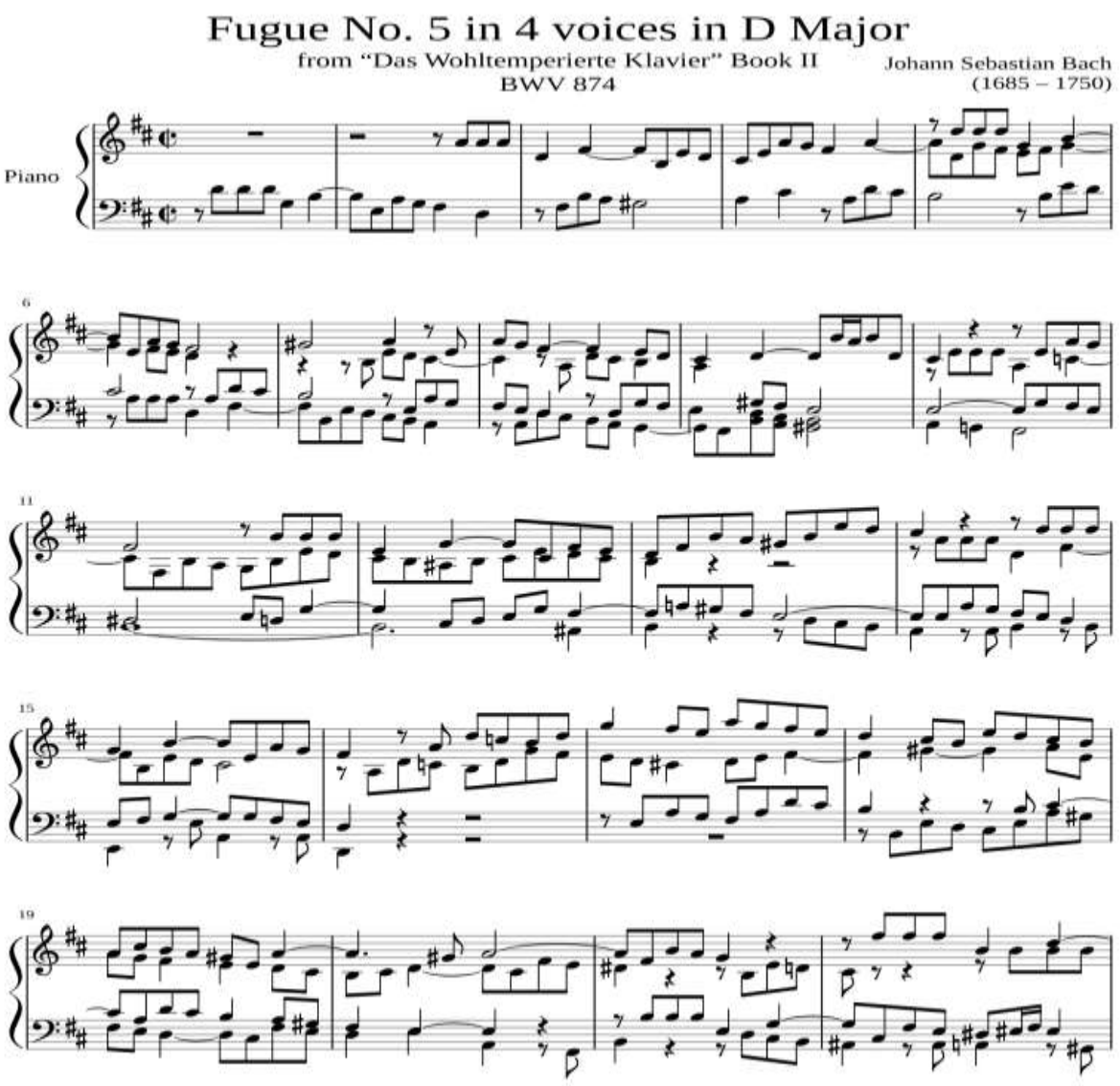
Bach: *Double Concerto for 2 violins in d minor*, BWV 1043
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Qcp8pvRkooY

The fast movement of Baroque music is always ***full of energy*** with a positive spirit showing the glamour of life.

Its slow movement is solemn and meditative.

Bach: ***Fugue*** *No.5 in D major, WTC. Bk II* BWV 874

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xbtHJUMGVJQ aerial view on keyboard



Baroque Opera

- Greek monody and drama--Medieval liturgical drama—Renaissance Madrigal Cycles and Pastoral—**Baroque Opera**.

- Earliest operas always used plots from Greek mythology
- The first opera was jointly composed by Peri & Caccini: *Euridice* 1600

Claudio Giovanni Antonio Monteverdi 1567-1643

Orfeo, a 5-Act **opera 歌剧** written in 1607

- Overture/Prelude 序曲,
- Aria 咏叹调 ，Recitativo 宣叙調, duet, trio, quartet, Chorus 合唱. vocal ensembles, dances, 40-piece orchestra to play 26 orchestral numbers.

- The first complete existing opera, sung in Italian. Orfeo is a character in *Greek mythology*.

- Conducted by Jordi Savall, Barcelona
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0mD16EVxNOM singing starts 2'56"
- Monteverdi Choir and Orchestra, | Teatro La Fenice (1792-), Venice. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c2snjRPl6yY
- conducted by Sir John Eliot Gardner

Baroque Representing Composers

- England: Purcell;
- France: Lully, Rameau;
- Italy: Monteverdi, Corelli, **Vivaldi**;
- Germany: Pachelbel, **Bach, Handel**;

- Public concerts started in England in 1672 followed by Germany in 1722 and France in 1725

- **Italian**



1. **Corelli** : Trio *Sonata* 奏鸣曲 in D, Op.3, No.2
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CwJRzYv6HNI from 2'06"

- 2. Antonio **Vivaldi** 1678-1741
- *The Four Seasons Concerto* 协奏曲
- No.1: *Spring* https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e3nSvIiBNFo Tiganyan
- No.3: *Summer* https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YuF4oYRktcA Nigel Kennedy

- **German**



- 3. **Pachelbel** : Canon （卡侬曲）in D
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JvNQLJ1_HQ0
- J.S. **Bach**
- **Handel**

French Baroque: aristocratic Louis XIII-XV

(Louis XIV the Sun King 1638-1715) : *Château de Versailles*

Lully: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TDBWHs43IzE from 00:31









English Baroque: festive, royal and grand



Charles I & II, King of England
James II, King of Scotland
Queen Anne united the Kingdom of England and Scotland

- Jeremiah **Clarke** 1674-1707: *The Prince of Denmark*
- first organist of the then newly-rebuilt St. Paul's Cathedral
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=n1n7WeuHCog music & sculpture
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DkogtWx0Pes Baroque Trumpet Ensemble Berlin

- Henry **Purcell** 1659-1695: *Trumpet Voluntary*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r3_pXUFEWbo



Late Baroque: **Rococo**

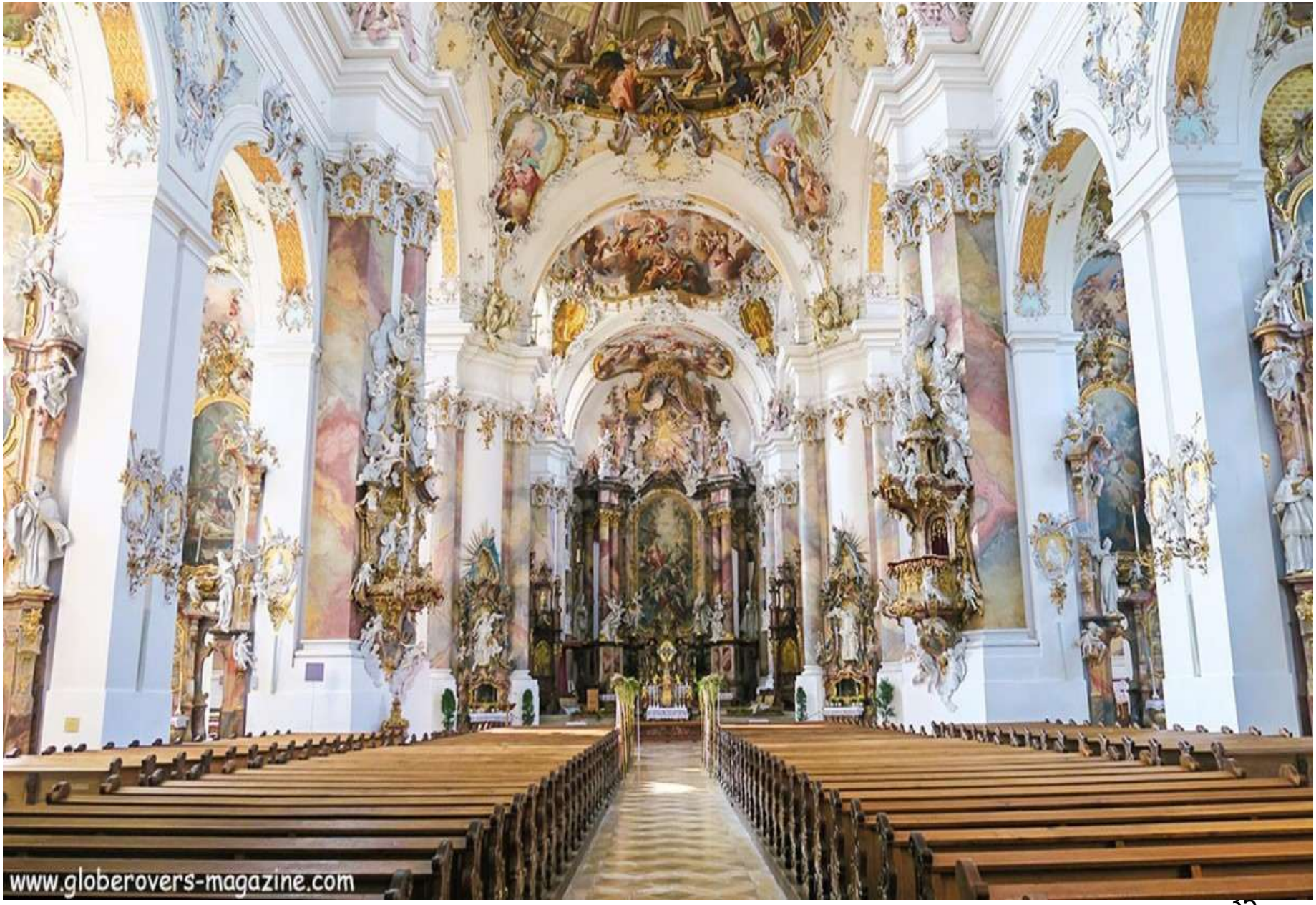
- Late Baroque with extreme featuring of *dense ornament*, illusive and theatrical yet more intimate.
- Can be found in today's Austria and Germany.

Difference of Baroque and Rococo

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=R-CgNTyQNCQ

- Characteristics of Rococo :

1. Light and playfulness,
2. The partial abandonment of symmetry, everything being composed of graceful lines and curves,
3. The huge quantity of asymmetrical curves and scrolls,
4. The very wide use of flowers in ornamentation, an example being festoons made of flowers,
5. Chinese and Japanese motifs : chinoiserie
6. Warm pastel colours (whitish-yellow, cream-colored, pearl greys, very light blues


www.globerovers-magazine.com

Queen of the Lake Church, Birnau by Lake Constance



Wies Kirche, Germany



Dwarfed lower part







Rococo tableware



Rococo tea set



Consolidation

- Baroque art: grand, colossal, royal/imperial
- Baroque music: grand, festive and royal.
- Music texture: complex, multi-linear.
- Many musical forms 曲式 established: Opera, Suite组曲, Fugue赋格曲，Sonata奏鸣曲.

- Leading to Rococo (even more ornated but intimate). https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DT2D7Kp3k3c

The Two Giants of the Baroque:
Johann Sebastian **Bach** 巴赫 1685-1750
Georg Fredric **Handel** 韩德尔1685-1759

- **Bach**
- *Toccata & Fugue* in d minor BWV 565 (1704) for organ
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=98w25S5yASc Karl Richter, beginning and 3'15"
- *Air* from Orchestral Suite No. 3 in D major BWV 1068 (1722-23) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tuB104s0Yas
- BWV= Bach-Werke-Verzechnis

- **Handel**
- *The Messiah* (1741) 53 numbers in 3 Parts: ***44. Hallelujah***
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1NNy289k6Oc King's College Choir, Cambridge.

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cWdB4jwC-EQ *Hallelujah* 1:11:20
- HK Oratorio Society. conductor: Chan Wing Wah



I worked hard. Anyone who works as hard as I did can achieve the same results.

(Johannes Sebastian Bach)

izquotes.com



"I should be sorry if I only entertain them I wish to make them better".

George Frideric Handel